GC

GC PILOT EA

VERSION 1.0

USER GUIDE

Expert Advisor for MetaTrader 5 · XAUUSD

Contents

1 Introduction
2 Requirements
3 Installation
4 Settings (Inputs)
5 On-chart status and buttons
6 Built-in protection
7 How to backtest
8 VPS
9 Troubleshooting
10 Risk warning
11 Support

1 Introduction

GC Pilot EA is an Expert Advisor (EA) for gold (XAUUSD) on MetaTrader 5. It can trade **BUY or SELL**. In each cycle the market picks the direction, and all positions in that cycle are managed as one **basket** with a single profit target.

How the EA works

1. **Straddle:** At the start of each cycle, the EA places one **Buy Stop** above price and one **Sell Stop** below price, at distance **D1**. Both orders are visible in the Trade tab.
2. **The market picks the direction:** When price triggers one order, the first position opens in that direction and the opposite order is deleted. The EA manages one direction per cycle. In rare cases, if price moves so fast that both orders trigger, each direction is managed as a separate basket with its own TP.
3. **Layers:** If price moves against the position, the EA adds layers with larger lots (**E1**) at a minimum spacing of **S1** / **S2**.
4. **Basket TP:** All positions in the basket share one TP: **T1** points from the basket average price (above the average for BUY, below it for SELL).
5. **New cycle:** After the basket closes, the EA places a new straddle.

> **Important**
>
> This is a grid / martingale strategy. It can book many small profits, but a large one-directional move can cause heavy losses or wipe out the account. Please read Sections 6 and 10 before using the EA on a real account.

2 Requirements

Item	Requirement
Platform	MetaTrader 5 (Windows desktop or VPS)
Account type	**Hedging.** Netting accounts are not supported. The EA stops with the message `GC Pilot requires an MT5 hedging account`.
Symbol	XAUUSD (gold), using your broker's symbol name, e.g. `XAUUSD`, `XAUUSD.m`, `GOLD`
Timeframe	Any timeframe. The EA does not depend on the chart timeframe. M5 is recommended for viewing.
Recommended capital	**Minimum 200,000 USD** (standard account) or **200,000 USC** (cent account), for V1 = 0.01. **More capital is better.** If you increase V1, increase capital in the same proportion.
License	**Live** accounts need a License Key. **Demo** accounts do not.
Internet	Required for license checks (live accounts). The URL `https://a689.link` must be allowed in WebRequest.
Strategy Tester	Backtesting is **allowed**. You can use the Strategy Tester to: • Review the EA's past performance, including maximum drawdown and the number of layers. • Work out a suitable capital for your chosen lot size. • Find suitable settings for other pairs. • Compare several settings before using them on a live account. Backtest results can differ from a live account due to spread, slippage and execution speed. Test new settings on a demo account first.

3 Installation

1. In MT5, open **File** → **Open Data Folder**, then go to the `MQL5\Experts` folder.
2. Copy `GC_Pilot_EA_v1.0.ex5` into that folder. If you use an older version, remove the old EA from the chart first.
3. Back in MT5, right-click **Expert Advisors** → **Refresh** in the **Navigator** window.
4. Open **Tools** → **Options** → **Expert Advisors**. Tick **Allow algorithmic trading** and **Allow WebRequest for listed URL**, then add `https://a689.link`. Click OK.
5. Open **one** XAUUSD chart. Drag the EA from the Navigator onto the chart.
6. In the **Common** tab, make sure **Allow Algo Trading** is ticked.
7. In the **Inputs** tab, enter your **License Key** (live accounts only) and review the other settings. Click OK.
8. Make sure the **Algo Trading** button on the MT5 toolbar is green.
9. Check the on-chart display. The status should read `ACTIVE` or `PAUSED (session boundary)`. The **STOP** and **CLOSE ALL** buttons appear on the chart.

> **Recommendation**
> Test the EA on a **demo** account for at least a few weeks before going live. Run **only one EA** per symbol in one account.

4 Settings (Inputs)

The values below are the defaults. "Point" means 0.01 for gold (e.g. 110 points = $1.10).

Input	Default	Description
=== A === License		
License Key	—	Your license key, format `XXXX-XXXXX-XXXXX-XXXXX`. Bound to your MT5 account number. Not needed on demo accounts.
=== B === Entry & lot		
D1	50	Distance (points) of the Buy Stop and Sell Stop from the current price at the start of a cycle.
V1	0.01	Lot for the first position. Must match your broker's minimum lot and volume step.
=== C === Grid & risk		
N	20	Maximum number of layers in one basket.
S1	110	Minimum spacing (points) between layers for layers 2 to 4.
S2	170	Minimum spacing (points) between layers for layer 5 onward.
T1	45	Basket TP (points), measured from the average price of all positions in the basket.
E1	1.60	Lot multiplier per layer. Example: 0.01 → 0.02 → 0.03 → 0.05 → 0.08 ... Large layers (50 lots and above) are opened automatically as several equal orders, each below 50 lots.
R1	0 (OFF)	**Max Basket Loss.** Basket loss limit as a fraction of the balance at the start of the cycle. 0.3 = 30%. See Section 6.
P1	3	Maximum slippage (points) for orders. Only effective on Instant Execution accounts.
H1	0 (OFF)	After a basket has been open longer than H1 hours, the EA closes it **only if** it is in profit or at breakeven. 0 = OFF.
=== D === Magic numbers		
M1	619731	ID number for BUY positions.
M2	619732	ID number for SELL positions. Must differ from M1. Only change if you know why.
=== E === Session pause & display		
F1	true	Stop new cycles near the daily market close and open (based on the broker's session schedule).
T2	60	Minutes before market close.
T3	25	Minutes after market open.
F2	true	Show EA status information on the chart. The STOP / START and CLOSE ALL buttons are always shown, even when F2 = false.
=== F === Daily target		
F3	false	Enable the daily profit target.
DT1	0	Daily profit target (account currency). Once reached, the EA stops opening new cycles until the next server day. Open baskets are still managed to TP.
=== G === News filter		
F4	true	Enable the news filter (MT5 economic calendar, USD news).
N1	Medium	Minimum news impact level that pauses new cycles.
T6	40	Minutes before the news.
T7	40	Minutes after the news.

5 On-chart status and buttons

When **F2 = true**, the EA shows information in the top-left corner of the chart: version, status, Max basket loss, news state, daily target (if enabled) and the pause window.

Status	Meaning
`ACTIVE`	The EA is running normally.
`ALGO TRADING OFF - enable it in MT5`	(Shown in red.) Algo Trading is disabled in MT5, so the EA cannot open or close orders. Turn on the **Algo Trading** toolbar button and **Allow Algo Trading** in the EA's Common tab.
`STOPPED (basket management active)`	The STOP button was pressed. No new cycles. Open baskets are still managed to TP. Press START to resume.
`PAUSED (session boundary)`	Inside the pause before market close or after market open. The `Resume in` line shows the time left. Open baskets are still managed.
`News: BLOCKED`	Important news is near. New cycles are paused and the straddle is removed. Open baskets are still managed.
`DAILY TARGET HIT`	The daily target was reached. No new cycles until the next server day.
`CLOSING BASKET`	The EA is closing a basket.
`CLEANUP RETRY`	The EA is trying to close remaining positions or orders but has not succeeded yet, e.g. the market is closed or the broker rejected the request. It retries automatically.
`GRID SAFETY LOCK`	The EA is waiting for broker confirmation of a layer order, so the layer is never opened twice. Released automatically.
`EQUITY RISK LOCK`	Max Basket Loss (R1) was reached. The basket was closed and no new cycles start until MT5 is restarted.
`LOCKDOWN (...)`	License problem. The EA opens no new cycles or layers. Existing baskets are still managed to TP. Contact your admin.

During news, session pause, STOP or the daily target, if a basket is still open, the dashboard shows the line `Open basket: managed to TP` with the reason. This means the EA only stops opening new cycles. Existing positions (including new layers) are still managed to TP. The Experts tab logs once when each pause starts and ends, e.g. `[NEWS]`, `[SESSION]`, `[DAILY]` and `[CONTROL]`.

On-chart buttons

Button	Function
STOP / **START**	**STOP:** no new cycles, and waiting Buy Stop / Sell Stop orders are deleted. Open baskets are still managed to TP. The STOP state is kept even after MT5 restarts. **START:** resume normal trading.
CLOSE ALL	Closes **all** positions and deletes all orders managed by this EA, after you click **Yes** on the confirmation popup. Manual trades and other EAs are not touched. The EA then switches to STOP automatically. Press START to resume.

6 Built-in protection

Max Basket Loss (R1)

When a cycle starts, the EA records the account balance. If the floating loss of all BUY and SELL positions managed by the EA reaches R1 × that balance, the EA will:

- Close all positions and delete all orders managed by the EA.
- Show `EQUITY RISK LOCK` and log `[RISK] Max basket loss reached` in the Experts tab.
- Not open new cycles. Removing and re-attaching the EA does **not** release the lock.

To resume trading, **fully restart MT5**. The lock is released once no positions or orders managed by the EA remain. Deposits, withdrawals, manual trades and other EAs are not counted in R1.

> **R1 = 0 means no loss limit**
> Without R1, a basket can keep losing until margin runs out. Choose R1 according to your capital and risk tolerance.

News filter

The EA pauses new cycles around USD news from the MT5 economic calendar (level N1 and above, from T6 minutes before to T7 minutes after). Key events such as FOMC, the Federal Funds Rate, Powell speeches and tariff news are always filtered. Open baskets are still managed.

Session pause

Gold spreads widen sharply around the daily market close and open. The EA does not start new cycles within T2 minutes before the close and T3 minutes after the open, based on the broker's session schedule.

Duplicate order protection

Every layer order is recorded before it is sent. If the broker is slow to confirm, the EA never sends the same order again (`GRID SAFETY LOCK`). If there is no order, deal or position evidence after 120 seconds, the record is released and the EA resumes automatically.

One EA per account and symbol

If two copies of GC Pilot with the same magic numbers are attached to the same symbol in the same account, the second copy stops with the message `Another GC Pilot instance already owns this account, symbol and magic-number book` .

If you run other EAs on the same account, make sure every EA uses **different** magic numbers. EAs that share a magic number on the same symbol can manage each other's positions.

7 How to backtest

You can test GC Pilot EA directly in the MT5 Strategy Tester to see the drawdown, work out a suitable capital and compare settings.

1. In MT5, press **Ctrl + R** (or **View** → **Strategy Tester**).
2. **Expert:** select `GC_Pilot_EA_v1.0.ex5`.
3. **Symbol:** select XAUUSD as named by your broker.
4. **Timeframe:** M1 or M5. The EA does not depend on the timeframe.
5. **Date:** choose **Custom period**, then set the start and end dates.
6. **Modelling: Every tick based on real ticks** (most accurate).
7. **Delays: Random delay** for conditions closer to a real account.
8. **Deposit & leverage:** match your account (see the table below).
9. **Visual mode:** tick it to watch the EA trade on the chart, or untick it for a faster test.
10. Press **Start**. The first run may be slow because MT5 needs to download tick data.

Account type	Deposit for V1 = 0.01
Standard (USD)	200000, currency USD
Cent (USC)	200000, currency USC. Log in to your cent account and select the cent symbol before backtesting, because cent symbols have a different contract size.

When it finishes, check the **Backtest** tab (Total Net Profit, Equity Drawdown Maximal) and the **Graph** tab. Test new settings on a demo account first.

8 VPS

- Use a VPS that runs 24 hours, ideally located close to your broker's server.
- Do not run the same EA on the same account on two computers at the same time.
- After a VPS restart, reopen MT5 and make sure Algo Trading is green.
- Check the status display and the Experts tab from time to time.

9 Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Dashboard shows `ALGO TRADING OFF`	Turn on the **Algo Trading** toolbar button (must be green) and **Allow Algo Trading** in the EA's Common tab.
`CLEANUP RETRY` does not go away	Check whether the market is closed or the broker is rejecting orders. The EA retries automatically.
Message `WebRequest not allowed`	Add `https://a689.link` in Tools → Options → Expert Advisors → Allow WebRequest for listed URL.
Invalid license / wrong account	Make sure the License Key is correct and bound to the MT5 account number in use. Contact your admin to change accounts.
Message `requires an MT5 hedging account`	Open a hedging-type account with your broker.
Message `Invalid trading inputs`	N, V1, S1, S2, T1 and E1 must be greater than 0. R1 cannot be negative.
Message `Magic_Buy and Magic_Sell must be different`	Set M1 and M2 to different values.
No straddle or new entries	Check the status: it may be STOPPED, PAUSED, News BLOCKED, DAILY TARGET HIT or EQUITY RISK LOCK. If STOPPED, press START.
Popup `CLOSE ALL is unavailable because this chart does not own the EA trade book`	The same EA is running on another chart for this account and symbol. Press CLOSE ALL on the chart that is managing the positions, or remove the extra EA.
Backtest results differ from demo / live	Normal. The Strategy Tester cannot fully reproduce real broker spread, slippage and execution speed. Use backtests as a guide, then confirm settings on a demo account.
Algo Trading turns OFF after switching accounts	Untick **Disable algorithmic trading when the account has been changed** in Tools → Options → Expert Advisors.

10 Risk warning

Please read carefully

- GC Pilot uses a **grid / martingale** strategy. Lot size increases as price moves against the basket.
- A long one-directional trend **can cause large losses or wipe out the account**.
- Past performance and backtests are **not a guarantee** of future results.
- Use **only money you can afford to lose**. Never use savings, loans or money you need for daily life.
- Recommended capital: minimum 200,000 USD (standard) or 200,000 USC (cent) for V1 = 0.01. More capital is better.
- Test on a demo account first. Withdraw profits regularly.
- GC Pilot provides software only. We do not manage your funds or give investment advice.

11 Support

Channel	Details
Help	Please contact **your admin** (the person who provided this EA and your License Key).

When asking for help, include a screenshot of the on-chart status display and the **Experts** tab.

Scam warning

We will **never** ask for your trading password. Only get help from your admin.